

Practice Exam

מבחן תרגול — תקני העבודה בטקסס

30 multiple choice questions and 15 written recall questions on 22 TAC 535.227 to 535.233. Every question comes from your own Texas SOP files, which were checked against trec.texas.gov on 22 August 2026.

Part 1	30 multiple choice, one answer each
Part 2	15 written recall — write the answer before you look
Pass mark	75% as a Professional Inspector. On Part 1 that is 23 of 30.
The real thing	25 questions covering both the Law module and this one, so expect roughly a dozen SOP questions on the day
Answer key	starts on its own page, with the citation for every answer

Wrong options appear here because a multiple choice question cannot exist without them, and because choosing between plausible options is the skill the state exam actually tests. None of them is an answer you have given before — these are fresh questions, not a replay of your review sheets. The answer key shows the correct answer and the reasoning only.

Part 1 — Multiple Choice

One answer each. Circle it and move on; do not go back until the end.

535.227(a)

1. The Standards of Practice apply when an inspector accepts employment to perform a real estate inspection for:

- A. A prospective buyer or seller
- B. A builder verifying his own work
- C. A lender underwriting the mortgage
- D. Any party who pays the inspection fee

535.227(a)

2. The Standards set the minimum requirements for an inspection of a:

- A. Single family dwelling of any size, complete or not
- B. Residential or light commercial building under eight units
- C. One to four family dwelling at any stage of construction
- D. One to four family dwelling that is substantially completed

535.227(c)

3. Under the general requirements, installed equipment and appliances must be operated:

- A. In at least one mode, using ordinary controls at typical settings
- B. In at least two modes, including any energy-saving setting
- C. Only where the client specifically requests it
- D. In every mode the manufacturer provides

535.227(c)

4. Which of the following is a general requirement unique to Texas?

- A. Delivering the report within three business days
- B. Completing the standard inspection report form promulgated by the Commission
- C. Providing the client with a written cost estimate for repairs
- D. Photographing every deficiency reported

535.227(d)

5. An inspector is NOT required to inspect any of the following EXCEPT:

- A. A sub-surface drainage system
- B. An elevator
- C. A deck attached to the dwelling
- D. A driveway or sidewalk

535.227(d)

6. Which is an inspector NOT required to determine?

- A. The type of foundation
- B. Whether a water heater relief valve has discharge piping
- C. The vantage point from which the attic was inspected
- D. The presence or absence of wood-destroying insects

535.227(e)

7. A general provision conflicts with a specific provision elsewhere in the Standards. Which governs?

- A. The specific provision
- B. Whichever imposes the greater duty on the inspector
- C. The inspector chooses, and documents the choice
- D. The general provision

535.227(f)

8. Which is NOT a valid ground for departing from inspecting a required component?

- A. The inspector and the client agree it is not to be inspected
- B. Conditions are hazardous to the health or safety of the inspector
- C. The component would take an unreasonable amount of time to inspect
- D. The inspector is not qualified to inspect it

535.228(a)

9. Regarding the foundation, a Texas inspector must:

- A. Render a written opinion as to its performance
- B. Describe its type and condition without opining
- C. Certify that it meets the code in force when built
- D. Recommend a structural engineer whenever any crack is present

535.228(a) and (d)

10. Which two subsections require the inspector to report the vantage point from which an area was inspected?

- A. Roof Covering Materials, and Roof Structures and Attics
- B. Interior Walls, and Porches and Decks
- C. Foundations, and Grading and Drainage
- D. Foundations, and Roof Structures and Attics

535.228(j)

11. A deck is attached to the dwelling. Is it within the scope of the inspection?

- A. Only if the client asks for it in writing
- B. Only if it is more than 30 inches above grade
- C. Yes, under the Porches, Balconies, Decks and Carports subsection
- D. No, decks are excluded by the general limitations

535.228

12. Which subsection of Structural Systems comes immediately after Foundations?

- A. Roof Covering Materials
- B. Grading and Drainage
- C. Exterior Walls, Doors and Windows
- D. Roof Structures and Attics

535.228(b)

13. Under Grading and Drainage, which is outside the standard?

- A. A sub-surface drainage system
- B. Grading that slopes toward the structure
- C. Standing water beside the foundation
- D. Surface drainage away from the structure

535.229(b)

14. What does a Texas inspector have to physically do with smoke and carbon monoxide alarms?

- A. Report their locations only
- B. Confirm they are hard-wired and interconnected
- C. Note their manufacture date and recommend replacement at ten years
- D. Manually test the installed and accessible ones

535.229(b)

15. The rule names the absence of GFCI protection as a deficiency in receptacles in which locations?

- A. Bathroom, garage, outdoor and crawl space
- B. Any location within six feet of a water source
- C. Bathroom, kitchen, garage and attic
- D. Kitchen, bathroom, laundry and basement

535.229(b)

16. Regarding branch circuits, the inspector shall report:

- A. The year the branch wiring was installed
- B. The type of branch circuit conductors
- C. The calculated load on each circuit
- D. The manufacturer of the overcurrent devices

535.229(a)

17. Which is reported as Deficient under Service Entrance and Panels?

- A. A panel manufactured before 1990
- B. A service drop that crosses the neighboring property
- C. A service drop, weatherhead or mast not securely fastened to the building
- D. A service rated below 150 amps

535.230

18. Section 535.230 covering heating, ventilation and air conditioning is divided into:

- A. Heating equipment, cooling equipment, and thermostats
- B. Equipment, distribution, and controls
- C. Gas heating, electric heating, and cooling
- D. Heating equipment, cooling equipment, duct systems, and general limitations

535.230

19. Which of these is outside the HVAC standard?

- A. Determining the adequacy or capacity of the system
- B. Reporting the condition of the ductwork
- C. Reporting deficiencies in the registers
- D. Operating the heating equipment in one mode

535.231

20. Which plumbing item has its own subsection under 535.231?

- A. Lawn irrigation systems
- B. Sump pumps
- C. Hydro-massage therapy equipment
- D. Private water wells

535.231(a)

21. Underground water supply lines are:

- A. Outside the standard, as buried or concealed items
- B. Inspected by pressure-testing the system
- C. Inspected only where a cleanout gives access
- D. Reported as Deficient if their type cannot be determined

535.231(b)

22. For a water heater, the standard asks you to report:

- A. Whether the unit is correctly sized for the dwelling
- B. The efficiency rating of the burner
- C. The remaining life expectancy of the tank
- D. Deficiencies in the relief valve and its discharge piping

535.232

23. A gas appliance connector is reported as Deficient when it:

- A. Is made of corrugated stainless steel
- B. Is not fitted with a shutoff valve at the appliance
- C. Exceeds six feet in length, or is concealed within a wall or partition
- D. Exceeds ten feet in length

535.232

24. An oven thermostat is reported as Deficient if it is not within:

- A. 10 degrees at a setting of 350 degrees F
- B. 25 degrees at a setting of 350 degrees F
- C. 50 degrees at any setting
- D. 25 degrees at a setting of 400 degrees F

535.232

25. What must be tested on a garage door operator?

- A. Operation, auto-reverse and the photoelectric sensors
- B. The height of the wall control above the floor
- C. Operation only
- D. The manual release rope height

535.232

26. Which is true of appliances under the Texas Standards?

- A. They are optional systems inspected only by agreement
- B. Only built-in appliances are covered, and only if under ten years old
- C. They are inspected but never reported as Deficient
- D. Texas requires them to be inspected; the national standard largely does not

535.233

27. Optional systems such as swimming pools and private wells are inspected:

- A. Only if the inspector agrees to inspect them
- B. Only by an inspector holding a separate endorsement
- C. Only if the client pays an additional fee
- D. Whenever they are present on the property

535.233(f)

28. For a private water well, the inspector must report:

- A. The results of a bacteriological test
- B. The type of pump and storage equipment, and the proximity of any known septic system
- C. The depth of the well and the age of the pump
- D. The reliability of the water supply

535.233(d)

29. For a swimming pool or spa, which are you NOT required to determine?

- A. The condition of the visible decking
- B. The presence of GFCI protection at accessible receptacles
- C. The effectiveness of entrapment covers
- D. Whether the pump operates

535.233(g)

30. For a private sewage disposal system, the inspector reports:

- A. The capacity of the tank in gallons
- B. Whether the system meets current county regulations
- C. The date the tank was last pumped
- D. The type of system and the location of the drain or distribution field

Part 2 — Written Recall

Write each answer out before you look at anything. Recognising a right answer and producing one from nothing are different skills, and the exam only tests the second.

535.227(a)

1. A builder hires you to inspect a house that is half finished. Do the Standards of Practice apply? Give the reason.

535.227

2. Name the seven parts of 535.227 in order.

535.227(c)

3. State the three general requirements.

535.227(f)

4. Name the three grounds for departure.

535.227(d)

5. Must you report a past repair that appears effective and workmanlike?

535.227(g)

6. Failure to comply with the Standards of Practice is grounds for what, under which authority?

535.228(a)

7. What must a Texas inspector do about a foundation that no national standard requires, and what two things must be reported alongside it?

535.228

8. List the ten subsections of Structural Systems in order.

535.229(b)

9. Name the affirmative testing duty in the branch circuits subsection, and the four GFCI locations the rule names.

535.230

10. What is the boundary between what you must do and what you need not do, across both the heating and cooling subsections?

535.231

11. Name the three subsections of Plumbing Systems, and say why the third one exists.

535.232

12. State both gas appliance connector deficiencies, and the oven thermostat tolerance.

535.232

13. Name six of the nine appliance subsections.

535.233

14. Name the five optional systems, and state the rule that governs all of them.

535.233(f)

15. For a private water well, name two things you must report as Deficient and two things you are not required to do.

Answer Key — Part 1

Mark yourself honestly. A near-miss is a miss.

1. **A — A prospective buyer or seller**

The scope names a prospective buyer or seller. Change the client and the SOP no longer govern the inspection. Lender and builder are the two the exam offers most.

535.227(a)

2. **D — One to four family dwelling that is substantially completed**

Three qualifiers, all testable: one to four family, not commercial; substantially completed, not mid-construction; and for a buyer or seller. Break any one and the SOP do not apply.

535.227(a)

3. **A — In at least one mode, using ordinary controls at typical settings**

At least one mode, ordinary controls, typical settings. This is the phrase to hold word for word — it recurs in the heating and cooling sections as the boundary of what operating means.

535.227(c)

4. **B — Completing the standard inspection report form promulgated by the Commission**

The report form is mandatory and promulgated under 535.222 and 535.223. You do not write your own format. Nothing comparable exists on the national exam.

535.227(c)

5. **C — A deck attached to the dwelling**

Attached porches, balconies, decks and carports are required under 535.228(j). Only DETACHED decks fall under the general exclusion. Elevators, sub-surface drainage and concrete flatwork are all genuinely excluded.

535.227(d)

6. **D — The presence or absence of wood-destroying insects**

The rule excludes determining the presence or absence of pests, termites and other wood-destroying insects or organisms, and the presence, absence or risk of asbestos, lead-based paint and other environmental hazards. The other three are required.

535.227(d)

7. **A — The specific provision**

Specific beats general. One line, and one of the easiest marks in the whole section.

535.227(e)

8. **C — The component would take an unreasonable amount of time to inspect**

The grounds are a closed list of three: client agreement, lack of qualification, or conditions that prevent inspection or are hazardous. Time and convenience are not on it. Departure is a limited permission, not a general license to skip things.

535.227(f)

9. **A — Render a written opinion as to its performance**

The single most distinctive rule in the Texas SOP. The national standard has you describe and report; Texas requires a judgment on performance. It is not an engineering analysis and not a warranty — it is how the foundation appears to be performing on the day, from what you could see.

535.228(a)

10. **D — Foundations, and Roof Structures and Attics**

Crawl space in (a), attic in (d). Texas wants the report to say where you looked from, because that defines what you could actually see.

535.228(a) and (d)

11. C — Yes, under the Porches, Balconies, Decks and Carports subsection

This is the trap that catches people, because the general limitations do exclude decks — but only detached ones. Attached is in, detached is out.

535.228(j)

12. B — Grading and Drainage

The order runs (a) Foundations, (b) Grading and Drainage, (c) Roof Covering Materials, (d) Roof Structures and Attics, then interiors, exteriors, glazing, stairways, fireplaces, and porches and decks last.

535.228

13. A — A sub-surface drainage system

Sub-surface drainage is excluded by the general limitations, along with concrete flatwork such as driveways and walkways. Everything visible on the surface is in.

535.228(b)

14. D — Manually test the installed and accessible ones

Texas makes you press the button. This is an affirmative duty, not an option, and it is one of the clearest departures from the national standard, where alarms are a knowledge question rather than a required action.

535.229(b)

15. A — Bathroom, garage, outdoor and crawl space

Bathroom, garage, outdoor and crawl space. The logic is the one you already know from the national exam: water, or at or below grade.

535.229(b)

16. B — The type of branch circuit conductors

Report the type of conductors. Anything requiring calculation is outside the standard, in this section and every other.

535.229(b)

17. C — A service drop, weatherhead or mast not securely fastened to the building

The named deficiencies are the drop, weatherhead or mast not securely fastened; absence of or deficiencies in the grounding electrode system; missing or damaged dead fronts or cover plates; conductors not protected from the edges of cabinets, gutters or cutout boxes; and deficiencies in cabinets, panels, clearances, overcurrent devices, bonding and grounding.

535.229(a)

18. D — Heating equipment, cooling equipment, duct systems, and general limitations

Four subsections, and the fourth being its own set of general limitations is worth noticing — HVAC gets extra exclusions on top of the ones in 535.227(d).

535.230

19. A — Determining the adequacy or capacity of the system

The recurring boundary across every technical section: operate and observe, yes; calculate, dismantle or determine adequacy, no. If an option asks you to size or rate something, it is outside the standard.

535.230

20. C — Hydro-massage therapy equipment

Whirlpool and jetted tubs get dedicated treatment because they are a plumbing fixture with an electric motor sitting in water — they straddle two systems. Irrigation and private wells are optional systems under 535.233, not plumbing.

535.231

21. A — Outside the standard, as buried or concealed items

Anything buried, hidden, latent or concealed is excluded by the general limitations, which puts most underground supply and drain lines outside the inspection.

535.231(a)

22. D — Deficiencies in the relief valve and its discharge piping

Your national-exam knowledge transfers directly. The difference is the Texas framing: the rule asks what you report as Deficient, not what the correct installation would be. Sizing and efficiency are outside every section.

535.231(b)

23. C — Exceeds six feet in length, or is concealed within a wall or partition

Two rules that travel together: longer than six feet, or concealed within or extending through walls, floors, partitions, ceilings or appliance housings. The six-foot rule also appeared on your national practice exams.

535.232

24. B — 25 degrees at a setting of 350 degrees F

Within 25 degrees at 350. Both numbers matter — the exam will change the setting as readily as the tolerance.

535.232

25. A — Operation, auto-reverse and the photoelectric sensors

A life-safety item, and Texas requires you to test it rather than merely observe it. The 60-inch control height and 72-inch release rope are national-exam facts; the Texas duty is the testing.

535.232

26. D — Texas requires them to be inspected; the national standard largely does not

Nine subsections of required appliance inspection, close to unique to the state exam. Worth disproportionate attention when the whole state portion is 25 questions.

535.232

27. A — Only if the inspector agrees to inspect them

They are not part of a standard inspection. But once you agree, the rule for that system applies in full — you cannot agree and then inspect casually.

535.233

28. B — The type of pump and storage equipment, and the proximity of any known septic system

Report the type of pump and storage equipment and the proximity of any known septic system. You are NOT required to open or remove components, determine the reliability of the supply, or locate underground leaks.

535.233(f)

29. C — The effectiveness of entrapment covers

Expressly excluded: the effectiveness of entrapment covers, the presence of shell or sub-surface leaks, and ancillary equipment such as computer controls, covers, chlorinators and water ionizers.

535.233(d)

30. D — The type of system and the location of the drain or distribution field

Type and location. The pattern holds across every optional system: report the type, report visible deficiencies, and determine nothing that requires digging, dismantling or testing.

535.233(g)

Answer Key — Part 2

1. A builder hires you to inspect a house that is half finished. Do the Standards of Practice apply? Give the reason.

No. The SOP apply to an inspection performed for a prospective buyer or seller, of a one to four family dwelling that is substantially completed. This fails on two qualifiers: the client and the stage of construction.
535.227(a)

2. Name the seven parts of 535.227 in order.

Scope, Definitions, General requirements, General limitations, Controlling provision, Departure provision, Enforcement.
535.227

3. State the three general requirements.

Operate fixed or installed equipment and appliances in at least one mode using ordinary controls at typical settings; visually inspect accessible systems from near proximity, including from inside the attic and crawl spaces; and complete the standard inspection report form required by 535.222 and 535.223.
535.227(c)

4. Name the three grounds for departure.

The inspector and client agree the item is not to be inspected; the inspector is not qualified to inspect it; or in the inspector's reasonable judgment conditions prevent inspection, or conditions or materials are hazardous to the inspector's health or safety.
535.227(f)

5. Must you report a past repair that appears effective and workmanlike?

No, unless a specific standard requires it. The same applies to cosmetic or aesthetic conditions and to wear and tear from ordinary use.
535.227(d)

6. Failure to comply with the Standards of Practice is grounds for what, under which authority?

Disciplinary action, as prescribed by Chapter 1102 of the Occupations Code.
535.227(g)

7. What must a Texas inspector do about a foundation that no national standard requires, and what two things must be reported alongside it?

Render a written opinion as to the performance of the foundation. Also report the type of foundation and the vantage point from which the crawl space was inspected.
535.228(a)

8. List the ten subsections of Structural Systems in order.

Foundations; Grading and Drainage; Roof Covering Materials; Roof Structures and Attics; Interior Walls, Ceilings, Floors and Doors; Exterior Walls, Doors and Windows; Exterior and Interior Glazing; Interior and Exterior Stairways; Fireplaces and Chimneys; Porches, Balconies, Decks and Carports.
535.228

9. Name the affirmative testing duty in the branch circuits subsection, and the four GFCI locations the rule names.

Manually test the installed and accessible smoke AND carbon monoxide alarms. GFCI: bathroom, garage, outdoor and crawl space receptacles.
535.229(b)

10. What is the boundary between what you must do and what you need not do, across both the heating and cooling subsections?

Operate and observe, yes; calculate, dismantle or determine adequacy, capacity or efficiency, no. If a question asks you to size or rate something, it is outside the standard.

535.230

11. Name the three subsections of Plumbing Systems, and say why the third one exists.

Plumbing Systems; Water Heaters; Hydro-Massage Therapy Equipment. The third exists because a whirlpool or jetted tub is a plumbing fixture with an electric motor sitting in water, so it straddles two systems.

535.231

12. State both gas appliance connector deficiencies, and the oven thermostat tolerance.

A connector exceeding six feet in length, and one concealed within or extending through walls, floors, partitions, ceilings or appliance housings. Oven thermostat: deficient if not within 25 degrees at a setting of 350 degrees F.

535.232

13. Name six of the nine appliance subsections.

General Provisions; Dishwasher; Food Waste Disposers; Range Hood and Exhaust Systems; Electric or Gas Ranges, Cooktops and Ovens; Microwave Ovens; Mechanical Exhaust Systems and Bathroom Heaters; Garage Door Operators; Dryer Exhaust Systems.

535.232

14. Name the five optional systems, and state the rule that governs all of them.

Landscape irrigation (sprinkler) systems; swimming pools, spas, hot tubs and equipment; outbuildings; private water wells; private sewage disposal (septic) systems. They are inspected only if the inspector agrees to inspect them — and once you agree, the full rule for that system applies.

535.233

15. For a private water well, name two things you must report as Deficient and two things you are not required to do.

Deficient: water pressure and flow and pressure switch performance; the condition of accessible equipment; the well head, including improper site drainage and clearances. Not required: open or remove components, determine the reliability of the supply, or locate underground leaks.

535.233(f)

Where You Landed

Part 1 is the one that maps onto the state exam, because it is the same format. You need 23 of 30 to clear 75%. Part 2 is harder than the exam on purpose — if you can produce these cold, the multiple choice version cannot surprise you.

Section	Questions	Got right	Notes
535.227 General Provisions	8		
535.228 Structural Systems	5		
535.229 Electrical Systems	4		
535.230 HVAC	2		
535.231 Plumbing Systems	3		
535.232 Appliances	4		
535.233 Optional Systems	4		
Total	30		

Any section where you dropped more than a quarter is worth rereading before you retake this. The Texas SOP is short enough to know completely — unlike the national exam, there is no realistic excuse for losing marks here.